ARVIND TIKU
Founder and Group Chairman, AT Capital

NAVIGATING THE AGE OF DISRUPTION

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Global conflicts and policy shifts are directly shaping how companies plan, invest and operate**
- **Businesses and nations must build flexible supply chains and multi-country relationships to survive constant disruptions**
- **India's growth story is strong, but policy stability and domestic manufacturing will determine how much it can capitalise**



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Arvind Tiku's central thesis is stark: business planning is no longer driven by markets, but by geopolitical volatility. Speaking at the India Today conclave, the founder and group chairman of AT Capital argued that shipping disruptions, wars in West Asia and sanctions have immediate, non-linear ripple effects. His prescription: adaptability is the only durable strategy. For India, this means diversifying supply chains, maintaining relationships across geopolitical blocs and acting opportunistically—as seen in its rapid scaling up of Russian oil imports. Tiku noted there is no easy replacement for Russian oil, nor is American energy a reliable long-term hedge due to pricing and supply constraints.

> **"The only thing certain about existing business is uncertainty. The day starts with geopolitics and it ends with geopolitics**
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> **If you look at the world and divide it into large blocks, India undoubtedly is a bright spot. We have a long way to go**

He flagged policy uncertainty as a business risk. Citing the US Inflation Reduction Act and policy reversals, he argued even advanced economies are no longer stable investment destinations. This raises the cost of long-term capital allocation and may dampen global investment cycles. He called India a relative "bright spot" due to its large domestic market, demographics and infrastructure demand. But its attractiveness will depend not just on demand but how it supports businesses through volatility.

On renewables, Tiku offered a reality check: India's dependence on Chinese supply chains for solar and batteries introduces a new layer of vulnerability. On real estate and urbanisation, he said India's under-penetrated housing demand remains an enduring investment theme.

Tiku's message was direct: the future belongs not to the biggest or the fastest, but to the most adaptable. ■